



China healthcare

Global Markets Research

20 July 2026

EQUITY: HEALTH CARE & PHARMACEUTICALS

Read-across on Samsung Bio's acquisition offer for PolyPeptide

Reflects attractiveness of peptide CDMO business, but not likely to impact China-based CDMO players in short run

On 20 July morning (local time), Samsung Biologics (207940 KS, Buy) announced to acquire a 100% stake in PolyPeptide Group AG (PPGN SW, Not rated), entering the peptide CDMO area. Our Korea Research team has published a report on this:

[Quick Note - Samsung Biologics \(207940 KS\) \(Buy\) Acquiring peptide CDMO company \(PolyPeptide\).](#)

We think this deal reflects the attractiveness of peptide CDMO, as stated in our anchor report: [Anchor Report: Global GLP-1 RAs - Asia players see opportunities](#), driven by the strong global demand for GLP-1 RAs – a major application area for peptide CDMO. The global market for peptide CDMO is also growing very fast.

Based on our understanding, the entry barrier to peptide CDMO is relatively high, as starting from scratch requires substantial effort and, more importantly, manufacturing capacity matters a lot. This explains why China-based CDMO players such as Wuxi Apptec (603259 CH/2359 HK, Buy) and Asymchem (002821 CH/6821 HK, Buy) have been investing heavily in capex over the past few years, and Samsung Biologics has announced to acquire PolyPeptide, even though the latter has made losses over the past three consecutive years.

According to PolyPeptide, its FY25 sales were EUR389mn, recording a CAGR of 10% during 2023-25, while Wuxi Apptec's TIDES business sales grew to CNY11bn in 2025 (c.EUR1.4bn by our calculation) at a CAGR of 49% over the same period.

As stated in our Anchor Report (link mentioned above), we think Asia CDMO's edge is efficiency, and we believe Samsung Bio's short-term goal would be to gain access to peptide CDMO knowhow and integrate PolyPeptide, rather than massive expansion.

Under these conditions, we don't foresee immediate capacity expansion for PolyPeptide that would challenge Wuxi Apptec's dominant position or deter Asymchem's rising capacity offering.

On running overseas CDMO facilities, we have witnessed unpleasant margin drag from such acquired facilities for several China-based CDMO players over the past few years, and hence, whether Samsung Bio can manage to turn around PolyPeptide efficiently needs to be closely monitored.

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Appendix A-1

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Materially mentioned issuers

Issuer	Ticker	Price	Price date	Stock rating	Sector rating	Disclosures
Asymchem	002821 CH	CNY 162.51	20-Jul-2026	Buy	N/A	
Samsung Biologics	207940 KS	KRW 1,345,000	20-Jul-2026	Buy	N/A	
Wuxi Apptec	2359 HK	HKD 157.20	20-Jul-2026	Buy	N/A	
Wuxi Apptec	603259 CH	CNY 124.22	20-Jul-2026	Buy	N/A	
Asymchem	6821 HK	HKD 121.00	20-Jul-2026	Buy	N/A	

Asymchem (002821 CH)

CNY 162.51 (20-Jul-2026) Buy (Sector rating: N/A)

Rating and target price chart (three year history)



For explanation of ratings refer to the stock rating keys located after chart(s)

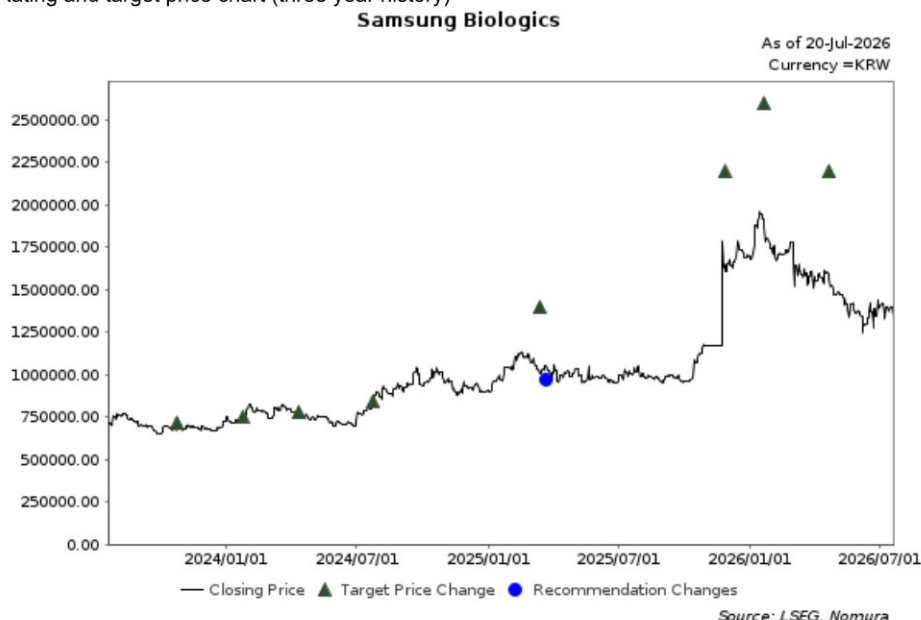
Valuation Methodology We derive our target price of CNY175.98 based on DCF model, assuming WACC of 10.0% and terminal growth of 4.0%. The benchmark index for the stock is CSI 300.

Risks that may impede the achievement of the target price Downside risks include: (1) order less than expected, due to potential overcapacity; (2) failure to win new projects; (3) overseas site loss widens

Samsung Biologics (207940 KS)

KRW 1,345,000 (20-Jul-2026) Buy (Sector rating: N/A)

Rating and target price chart (three year history)



Date	Rating	Target price	Closing price
22-Apr-26		2,200,000.00	1,561,000.00
21-Jan-26		2,600,000.00	1,873,000.00
27-Nov-25		2,200,000.00	1,646,000.00
14-Mar-25	Buy		1,006,028.00
14-Mar-25		1,400,000.00	1,006,028.00
24-Jul-24		840,000.00	845,216.00
11-Apr-24		780,000.00	760,982.00
24-Jan-24		750,000.00	754,281.00
25-Oct-23		720,000.00	692,063.00

For explanation of ratings refer to the stock rating keys located after chart(s)

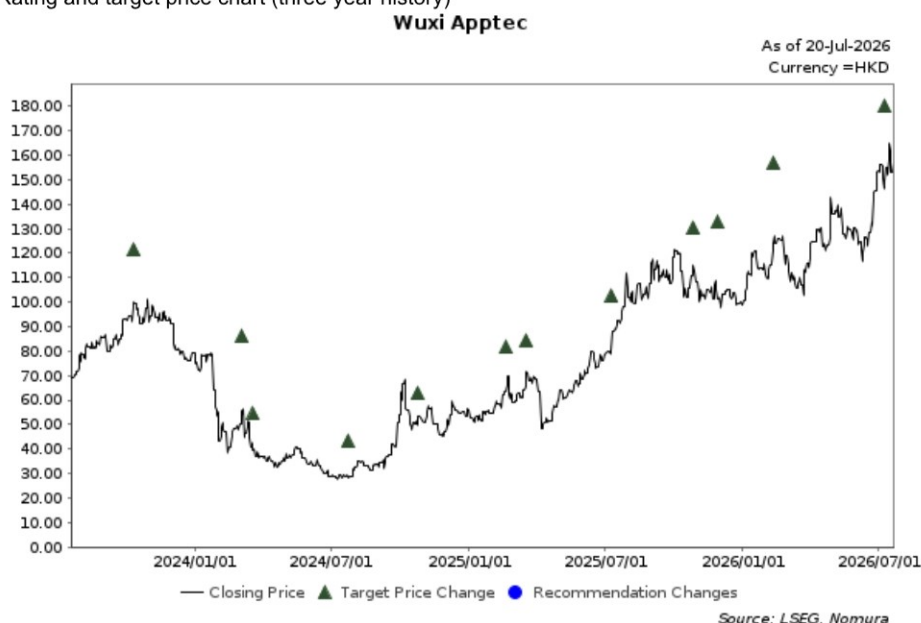
Valuation Methodology Our target price of KRW2,200,000 is based on DCF valuation, where we value: 1) revenue from the CMO business growing at 10%p.a. during 2026-35F, 2) average OPM of 47% during 2026-35F and 3) with a WACC of 6.8% and a terminal growth rate of 3.0%. The benchmark index for the stock is KOSPI200.

Risks that may impede the achievement of the target price Downside risks include delay in plant construction.

Wuxi Aptec (2359 HK)

HKD 157.20 (20-Jul-2026) Buy (Sector rating: N/A)

Rating and target price chart (three year history)



Date	Rating	Target price	Closing price
09-Jul-26		180.22	149.00
11-Feb-26		157.07	123.90
28-Nov-25		132.80	101.20
27-Oct-25		130.63	115.00
10-Jul-25		102.77	79.80
18-Mar-25		84.59	71.93
19-Feb-25		81.70	63.73
24-Oct-24		63.12	49.66
23-Jul-24		43.45	28.78
19-Mar-24		54.56	39.32
04-Mar-24		86.23	56.22
12-Oct-23		121.70	99.91

For explanation of ratings refer to the stock rating keys located after chart(s)

Valuation Methodology We derive our target price of HKD180.22 based on DCF model, assuming WACC of 10.1% and terminal growth of 3.5%. The benchmark index for the stock is Hang Seng Index.

Risks that may impede the achievement of the target price Downside risks include: (1) growth slowdown due to potential higher competition or lower demand. (2) geopolitical tensions: the company was included on US Department of Defense's updated 1260H list, which it filed a law suit against

Wuxi Apptec (603259 CH)

CNY 124.22 (20-Jul-2026) Buy (Sector rating: N/A)

Rating and target price chart (three year history)

Wuxi Apptec

Source: LSEG, Nomura

Date	Rating	Target price	Closing price
09-Jul-26		164.00	121.07
11-Feb-26		142.93	102.14
28-Nov-25		120.85	91.19
27-Oct-25		118.83	106.64
11-Jul-25		93.49	77.15
18-Mar-25		86.89	69.68
19-Feb-25		83.93	62.50
24-Oct-24		64.84	50.14
23-Jul-24		58.65	39.20
19-Mar-24		63.75	50.81
04-Mar-24		100.74	60.00
12-Oct-23		142.19	89.30

For explanation of ratings refer to the stock rating keys located after chart(s)

Valuation Methodology We value the company at CNY164.00 based on DCF model with WACC of 10.1% and terminal growth rate of 3.5%. The benchmark index for the stock is SHSZ 300.

Risks that may impede the achievement of the target price Downside risks include: (1) growth slowdown due to potential higher competition or lower demand. (2) geopolitical tensions: the company was included on US Department of Defense's updated 1260H list, which it filed a law suit against

Asymchem (6821 HK)

HKD 121.00 (20-Jul-2026) Buy (Sector rating: N/A)

Rating and target price chart (three year history)

Asymchem

Source: LSEG, Nomura

Date	Rating	Target price	Closing price
09-Jul-26		131.48	115.30
31-Mar-26		115.43	91.00
26-Aug-25		114.68	91.40
24-Apr-25		55.23	52.35
11-Jul-24		76.45	46.60
26-Apr-24		83.94	63.35
01-Mar-24		90.12	70.25
24-Oct-23		134.59	111.10

For explanation of ratings refer to the stock rating keys located after chart(s)

Valuation Methodology We derive our target price of HKD131.48 based on DCF model, assuming WACC of 10.0% and terminal growth of 4.0%. The benchmark index for the stock is Hang Seng Index.

Risks that may impede the achievement of the target price Downside risks include: (1) order less than expected, due to potential overcapacity; (2) failure to win new projects; (3) overseas site loss widens

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